

AUDIOPHILE

Brand	Sennheiser	Sennheiser	Logic3	Logic3	MartinLogan	Blaupunkt	Blaupunkt	
Model no.	HD700	RS 220	Ferrari T350	Ferrari R200	Mikros-90	CN-112 Comfort	Style	
Price (₹)	59,990	29,990	24,990	18,990	18,900	9,990	14,990	
Performance (Out of 70)	63	16.29	55.25	46.69	46.65	36.31	43.36	
Features (Out of 20)	17.81	13.89	12.84	11.2	7.21	8.97	8.46	
Build Quality (Out of 10)	5.2	2.3	5.2	4.7	2.3	4.8	4.3	
Total (Out of 100)	86.01	32.48	73.29	62.59	56.16	50.08	56.13	
Specifications								
Impedance (ohm)	150	150	32	32	26	32	32	
Frequency response	15 – 40,000 Hz	16 - 22,000 hZ	20-20,000Hz	20-20,000Hz	6–22,000 Hz	15 - 23,000 Hz	20 - 22,000 Hz	
Chord length (m)	3	NA	NA	1.2	1.2	1.3	1.3	
Weight (g)	270	329	NA	NA	163	NA	230	
Driver diameter (mm)	40mm	NA	40mm	40mm	35mm	40mm	40mm	
Sensitivity	NA	106 dB	110dB	110dB	98dB	102 dB		
Type (circum/supra)	Circumaural	Circumaural	Closed, Noise cancelling	Supraaural	Supraaural	Closed, Noise Cancelling	Closed, Circumaural	
Performance Tests								
Audio Tracks								
Santana - While my guitar - guitar	90	30	80	60	60	62	60	
Dream Theater - Pull me under - metal	95	10	85	68	65	60	68	
Chris Rea - Call On Me - vocals	95	25	75	70	75	60	72	
BTBAM - Selkies - instrument density	95	20	80	70	70	50	70	
Motherjane - Mindstreet	90	20	80	70	72	52	70	
Massive Attack - Angel - bass	87	20	82	75	70	40	45	
Bedoin Sound Clash - Brutal hearts - percussion	85	20	80	70	70	45	50	
Frequency samples								
20 Hz	90	10	60	50	50	50	60	
30 Hz	95	10	80	40	40	40	60	
50 Hz	95	10	80	40	40	40	60	
100 Hz	95	10	80	50	50	40	50	
250 Hz	95	50	80	60	60	60	70	
Qualitative								
Aesthetics	95	60	90	80	90	70	80	
Soundstaging	90	20	80	85	75	50	60	
Stereo separation	95	40	80	85	75	55	75	
Build								
Materials used	90	80	95	95	95	70	80	
Cable quality - sheathed wovnen etc	98	80	85	50	20	20	40	
Comfort								
Headband clamping	100	80	60	50	30	55	30	
Earpads	100	60	60	60	30	50	50	
Extended listening	100	80	50	50	20	50	30	
Features								
Hard case	0	0	10	10	10	10	10	
Foldable (5 - single axis, 10 - fully foldable)	0	0	0	0	5	5	5	
Replaceable cables	0	10	10	10	10	10	10	
Adapters	0	10	10	10	10	10	10	
Braided cable	10	0	10	10	0	0	0	
Wire length (0 for 1.5m 10 for >1.5m)	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	
Wireless	0	10	0	0	0	0	0	
ANC	0	0	10	0	0	10	0	

fumble. Except the loose bass the iBall Base O9 overall isn't bad. Dream Theater with all the complexity and instrument density sounded decent enough. But the bass on Call On Me was quite boomy but the vocal clarity was passable. Nominally the best performer was the **Logitech H800** but

not by a great margin. In fact in the wireless space we had a much better wireless portable with us last year – the TDK WR. Neutral sounding, and high fidelity over the air transmission thanks to Klear technology, it left a lasting impression. Sadly it wasn't in attendance for this comparison.

But overall none of the headphones performed as per our expectation, so there is no best performer award. Going by our price to performance index, the iBall Base O9 gets the Best Buy.

GAMING HEADSETS

Gamers are a very varied and interesting breed. Picking out

the right headset for such a creature is an arduous task and is more akin to trying to settle a Quake 3 vs. DOTA debate. After much head-scratching, we settled on the following.

Hardcore gamers

This is a special breed of gamer, one that will quake in its boots